

Understanding Anxiety

*Write your thoughts, pause, or talk to a trusted adult whenever you feel ready.
When worry or fear feels difficult to switch off*

WHAT IT FEELS LIKE

When worry, fear, or 'what if?' thoughts feel difficult to switch off, even when you're safe. Your nervous system is trying to protect you, but it has sounded a false alarm.

GROUNDING RESET

'Right Now' Reset (5-4-3-2-1 Technique)

Name 5 things you can see, 4 things you can feel with your hands, 3 things you can hear around you, 2 things you can smell, and 1 thing you like about yourself. Then write: 'What is actually happening right now in this exact moment?'

Take 3 slow breaths. You do not need to rush or figure everything out at once.

REPUTABLE RESOURCE & FURTHER READING

<https://www.nhs.uk/every-mind-matters/mental-wellbeing-tips/youth-mental-health/>

Visit this resource online for in-depth adolescent mental health guides and worksheets.

IMPORTANT SAFETY & EDUCATIONAL NOTICE

Heard & Healed is a supportive and educational platform designed to help young people understand their emotions, reflect on what they are experiencing, and find helpful resources. It is not a substitute for therapy, counselling, medical care, diagnosis, or professional mental-health support.

Free 24/7 Helpline: 1098 / 988 / 14416 | Website: heardandhealed.org